Category Policy Addendum: Groceries

KARTWAY OPERATIONS MANUAL
ADDENDUM 4.8: GROCERIES CATEGORY POLICY
Effective Date: 14 January 2025
Applies to: All Tier-1 and Tier-2 Customer Operations Agents

4.8.1 Scope and Precedence This addendum governs all customer service transactions, exception handling, and dispute resolutions for items listed under the Kartway Groceries category. In the event of a conflict between this addendum and the General Marketplace Policy, the clauses herein shall supersede.

4.8.2 Returns Window and Non-Returnability 1. General Rule: All grocery items sold on the Kartway marketplace are strictly non-returnable. This provision aligns with Section 2.1 of the General Returns Policy. 2. Physical Returns Prohibition: Agents are expressly prohibited from issuing return shipping labels or requesting that customers ship grocery items back to fulfillment centers or third-party sellers. 3. Disposal Mandate: If an item is spoiled, contaminated, or delivered in error, the customer shall be instructed to safely dispose of or retain the product locally. Under no circumstances shall food items be accepted at any Kartway return drop-off location.

4.8.3 Condition Requirements and Packaging Mandates 1. Condition Standards: Groceries must arrive at the delivery address in a condition fit for immediate consumption or standard pantry storage. 2. Original Packaging: Original manufacturer or vendor packaging is mandatory for all claims of unsealed, tampered, or damaged goods. A claim will be rejected if the item has been removed from its primary containment vessel, except where the defect was concealed within the primary packaging (e.g., foreign objects). 3. Compromised Seals: Items with broken safety seals upon delivery are classified as damaged-in-transit and qualify for resolution under Section 4.8.6.

4.8.4 Restocking Fees 1. Fee Assessment: A standard restocking fee of 15% of the purchase price shall be applied to any grocery order intercepted by the customer while in transit and successfully redirected back to the merchant, provided the cancellation request was initiated less than 3 hours prior to the scheduled delivery window. 2. Waived Fees: Restocking fees are entirely waived for orders cancelled prior to warehouse dispatch or for merchant-fault delivery failures.

4.8.5 Perishable and Hazardous Handling Rules 1. Perishable Identification: Items classified as perishable (including dairy, fresh produce, frozen goods, and raw meats) must maintain cold-chain integrity during transit. 2. Reporting

Deadline: Customers reporting temperature abuse, spoilage, or missing cold-pack insulation must submit photographic evidence via the Kartway Resolution Portal within 4 hours of the recorded timestamp of delivery. Claims submitted after this window shall be automatically closed without compensation. 3. Hazardous Groceries: Certain pressurized culinary items (such as whipped cream chargers or cooking spray aerosols) are subject to hazardous material transport rules. Damaged hazardous groceries must not be handled by standard postal returns; instead, agents must issue an immediate digital refund without requiring physical inspection.

4.8.6 Warranty Period 1. Defect Coverage: The standard warranty period for shelf-stable grocery items purchased on Kartway is 7 calendar days from the date of delivery. 2. Perishable Exemption: For fresh and frozen perishables, the warranty period expires exactly 24 hours post-delivery. No refund or replacement requests for perishables shall be entertained after this 24-hour threshold has elapsed.

End of Addendum 4.8 — Document ID: KW-POL-GRO-9912